



members. The sense of community within the club was so warm that it quickly became an integral part of our lives," he recalls in an interview with *Sportstar*.

Gademan had to wait 21 more years before witnessing his club play in the Hoofdklasse, the premier hockey league in the Netherlands. He experienced it firsthand as the captain, playing alongside his brother.

On June 10, 2017, at Almere's home ground, Gademan collapsed to the turf, hands on his head, after his team won a penalty shootout against Schaerweijde to retain its

place in the division. That match, however, also marked Gademan's final game as a professional hockey player at the age of 27.

Eight months prior, outgoing coach Alex Verga had asked Gademan to take over the reins at Almere.

"It was a big decision because I loved playing, but I knew as a player, I had reached my limit," says Gademan, who played as a defender.

Like many young Europeans, Gademan spent hours devising tactics while playing Football Manager, a football-themed

Making it big: At 32, Pasha Gademan has already achieved significant milestones, including a World Cup win with Germany as an assistant coach, Bundesliga titles with Rot-Weiss, and coaching Canada at the Olympics.

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computer game. However, no simulation could prepare him for coaching in the top division of Dutch hockey. In the years leading up to his eventual retirement, Gademan had been coaching the Almere youth team, training future stars like Jonas de Geus, the Olympic 2024 gold